

Lulu the Ladybug's Missing Spot

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Lulu was a tiny red ladybug. She lived on a daisy in the flower garden. Lulu had seven black spots. She counted them every morning. One, two, three, four, five, six, seven. Her spots were her pride. One rainy morning, Lulu woke up. She counted her spots. One, two, three, four, five, six. Six! One spot was missing! Lulu gasped. She looked all over the daisy. No spot. She felt upset. Her wings trembled. "I am not a proper ladybug!" she cried. She felt sad. She hid under a petal.



Her friend Roly the pill bug rolled over. Pill bugs roll into balls, and Roly was very good at rolling. "Why are you hiding, Lulu?" asked Roly. "I lost a spot," sniffed Lulu. "Now I only have six." Roly unrolled and looked. "You are still Lulu," he said. "You are perfect, spots and all." "You are perfect, spots and all." Lulu repeated it softly. "You are perfect, spots and all." It became her comforting words. "You are perfect, spots and all."



Roly had a sweet idea. "Let us paint a new spot," he said. "With berry juice!" They found a ripe blackberry. Squelch! Roly dabbed the juice with a grass blade. Carefully, he painted a round spot. Pat pat pat. Lulu looked at her reflection in a dewdrop. Seven spots again! One, two, three, four, five, six, seven. Lulu giggled. "It tickles!" she said. She felt happy. She felt loved. Her friend had helped her feel whole.



Can you count Lulu's spots? One, two, three, four, five, six, seven! Now count them backwards: seven, six, five... Then it started to rain again. Pitter patter. Oh no! The berry-juice spot began to wash away. Drip drip. Lulu watched it fade. But she did not cry. "You are perfect, spots and all," she said. Six spots or seven. She was still Lulu. Roly smiled. "That is the bravest thing," he said. They danced in the rain. Six spots shining.



When the rain stopped, a rainbow appeared. Lulu rested on the daisy. Roly curled under a leaf. "Goodnight, perfect ladybug," whispered Roly. "Goodnight," yawned Lulu. She counted her spots one last time. Six, and that was fine. The garden smelled fresh and sweet. The petals rocked gently. And Lulu slept, perfect, spots and all.

***Moral:** You are wonderful exactly as you are.*

The End